Enterprise Finance Data Trust Transformation

Executive Case Study

Solving enterprise financial reporting conflicts through governance, ownership alignment, and KPI certification.

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Executive Summary — Finance Data Trust Transformation

Enterprise finance reporting was slowed by **structural data ownership issues** rather than technology limitations.

Key Enterprise Problems Identified

Multiple versions of financial truth

Revenue differed by $27M across Trading, Finance, and Regulatory Reporting.

No enterprise KPI ownership

Critical metrics lacked clear accountability.

Conflicting business definitions

Wholesale accounts, liquidity ratios, and RWA calculated differently across functions.

Manual reconciliation dependency

Finance teams resolving disputes instead of enabling decisions.

Integration and timing dependencies

Upstream data delays impacting executive reporting.

What Was Solved

- Single certified KPI definitions established
- Clear ownership assigned to finance data domains
- Conflicting definitions resolved through governance
- Manual reconciliation reduced through control alignment
- Executive reporting stabilized

Executive Outcome

- Faster decision cycles
- Reduced reporting disputes
- Improved regulatory confidence
- Trusted enterprise financial reporting

Leadership takeaway: Finance transformation succeeds when ownership, definitions, and accountability are aligned.

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Finance Leaders Could Not Rely on Enterprise Financial Numbers

Same KPI produced different answers:

Net Trading Revenue — Three Versions

$482M

Trading

$468M

Finance Product Control

$455M

Regulatory Reporting

$27M

Variance

Root Causes

- Different calculation logic
- Timing differences between reporting groups
- Unclear KPI ownership
- Manual adjustments not aligned
- Regulatory interpretation differences

Executive Impact

- Delayed decisions
- Reporting disputes
- Manual reconciliation effort
- Reduced reporting confidence
- Regulatory exposure

> The disconnect is not data quality. The disconnect is **enterprise alignment**.

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Multiple Critical Finance KPIs Lacked Enterprise Agreement

Examples of conflicting numbers across functions:

KPI	Version A	Version B	Impact
Wholesale account population	1,842 accounts	1,615 accounts	227 account discrepancy
Liquidity ratio	132%	128%	4% variance
Risk weighted assets	$92B	$95B	$3B difference
Reconciliation breaks	412	289	123 unresolved items

Why This Occurred

- Different definitions
- Different ownership
- Different calculation timing
- Different control standards

Business Risk

- Unreliable executive reporting
- Regulatory reporting exposure
- Operational inefficiency
- Delayed finance decisions

> Finance cannot operate efficiently when core numbers are **debated instead of trusted**.

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Wholesale Account Definition Conflict

The Problem

Trading and Regulatory Reporting used **different definitions** of wholesale accounts.

Result

227 accounts classified differently.

Root Causes

- No updated enterprise definition
- No certification process
- No ownership accountability
- No control validation

Resolution Implemented

Enterprise wholesale definition created:

Accounts must support wholesale operations

Meet transaction activity criteria

Remain within 20% of 90-day balance average

- Assigned ownership to Wholesale Operations
- Established certification process

Result

- Single enterprise population established.
- Reporting conflict eliminated.
- Executive discussions no longer delayed.

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Finance Data Trust Operating Model Implemented

Before

- Multiple KPI versions
- Manual reconciliation
- Unclear ownership
- Reporting disputes
- Reactive issue resolution

After

- Certified KPI definitions
- Defined ownership
- Governed calculation logic
- Control processes established
- Single enterprise numbers

Result

Faster reporting cycles

Reduced reconciliation effort

Improved executive confidence

Improved regulatory alignment

> Finance KPIs were transformed into **governed enterprise assets.**

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Key Finance Transformation Outcomes

Problems Resolved

- Revenue definition conflicts
- Wholesale account classification disputes
- Reconciliation ownership gaps
- Liquidity metric inconsistencies
- Regulatory reporting alignment issues

Operational Improvements

- Reduced reporting disputes
- Reduced manual adjustments
- Faster close cycles
- Improved regulatory readiness
- Improved data accountability

Executive benefit: Time is spent making decisions instead of debating numbers.

Decision-Grade Finance Reporting Enabled

Executive Performance View

$32.75M
Actual Revenue

$32.71M
Plan Revenue

-1.4%
Variance Clarity

Confidence Indicators

- 34 certified records
- 2 pending review items
- Clear ownership established

Business Impact

- Faster executive decision cycles
- Reduced reporting disputes
- Trusted financial performance tracking
- Improved finance confidence

> Finance reporting moved from **debate to confidence.**

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Measurable Business Impact

68	22	52hrs
Finance users enabled	Manual reports eliminated	Saved per week

Value Delivered

- Cost reduction
- Speed to insight
- Control improvement
- Risk reduction
- Operational efficiency

> **Executive takeaway:** Finance transformation is achieved by aligning ownership, definitions, and accountability and not by adding more technology.

How Enterprise Finance Alignment Was Achieved

Leadership Actions

01

Defined KPI ownership

02

Standardized definitions

03

Aligned stakeholders

04

Created governance escalation paths

05

Institutionalized accountability

Leadership Focus

Solve conflicts rather than build reports.

Align incentives across finance functions.

Create enterprise ownership clarity.

Result

Finance leaders aligned around one version of truth.

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Enterprise Finance Data Transformation Outcome

Problems Solved

- Revenue conflicts
- KPI ownership gaps
- Definition inconsistencies
- Reporting disputes
- Manual reconciliation burden

Business Results

- Trusted executive reporting
- Faster finance decisions
- Improved regulatory confidence
- Reduced operational friction
- Improved finance operating model

Key leadership principle: Enterprise data problems are operating model problems. Solve ownership and governance, and trust follows.

STRATEGIC PERSPECTIVE

Enterprise Scalability of This Model

This operating model applies across:

- Finance transformation
- Regulatory reporting
- Risk data programs
- AML data platforms
- Enterprise data governance
- Data platform modernization

Organizational Impact

- Reduces regulatory risk
- Improves finance execution
- Accelerates decision making
- Improves enterprise data maturity

> **Executive perspective:** This approach scales across any enterprise where financial data must be trusted.

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My Enterprise Data Transformation Playbook

Step 1 — Identify enterprise conflicts

Find where critical KPIs differ across functions and quantify the business impact.

Step 2 — Establish ownership

Assign clear KPI ownership aligned to the groups best positioned to maintain the data.

Step 3 — Standardize definitions

Create enterprise definitions agreed across Finance, Risk, Operations, and Regulatory Reporting.

Step 4 — Implement governance controls

Establish certification processes, validation checkpoints, and escalation paths.

Step 5 — Align stakeholders

Drive agreement across business, technology, and control functions.

Step 6 — Institutionalize the operating model

Embed governance into delivery processes so trust becomes repeatable.

Leadership philosophy: Enterprise data trust is not a technology issue. It is an ownership, governance, and operating model issue.

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